

Hypsilophodon

HIP-sih-LOAF-oh-don



- **When** 125–120 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** England, Spain
- **Habitat** Forests
- **Length** 7 ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Hypsilophodon was much like a modern deer, grazing on tender plants with its small, leaf-shaped teeth. Fossil footprints grouped together hint that these creatures roamed in herds like deer, though this is far from certain. Its stiff tail and long legs and feet show it was a fast-running ground animal, able to flee swiftly from predators on its hind legs while using its tail for balance.

Leaellynasaura

lee-ELL-in-ah-SORE-ah



- **When** 105 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Australia
- **Habitat** Forests
- **Length** 7 ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Leaellynasaura lived near the South Pole. Although it was less cold here during the Cretaceous Period than it is today, *Leaellynasaura* would have had to live without sunlight for several months of the year during polar winters. It had large eyes, which helped it see better in the dark and avoid predators. It was probably warm-blooded.



Lesothosaurus

li-SUE-too-SORE-us



- **When** 200–190 million years ago (Early Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** S. Africa
- **Habitat** Desert plains
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Leaves, perhaps dead animals and insects

This dinosaur was named after Lesotho, the south African country where its fossils were first found in 1978. Scientists think *Lesothosaurus* was similar to a modern gazelle, grazing on low-lying plants and running away quickly at the first sight of predators. Its upper and lower teeth were small and shaped like arrowheads.



Othnielosaurus

oth-nee-ELL-oh-SORE-us



- **When** 155–145 million years ago (Late Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 7 ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Othnielosaurus moved swiftly on its strong back limbs, which were built for running. Its front limbs were short and weak, and its hands and fingers were small. Fossils show that its teeth were edged with many small ridges, making them well-suited for shredding leaves. Its vertebrae show that it had a short neck.

